

LESSON 8 WORKSHEET

Preparing your heart: the week before

How do I get ready inside, not only outside?

None of this is a test of readiness. If you cannot do all of it, you can still take the retreat honestly.

Your main step: begin the seven-psalm week

Day, time and place I will begin:

Day	Psalm	Simple focus	Done
1	Psalm 23	God's care	☐
2	Psalm 62	Rest and waiting	☐
3	Psalm 27	One central desire	☐
4	Psalm 42	Spiritual thirst	☐
5	Psalm 63	Longing for God	☐
6	Psalm 139	Honest self-examination	☐
7	Psalm 131	Quiet trust	☐

Each day: read the psalm twice, the second time more slowly · sit quietly for up to three minutes (one minute is fine; eyes open is fine; or walk gently while repeating a line) · pray one sentence: "Lord, I am coming to be with you. Prepare me, and prepare the days." Fewer than seven days? Choose the psalms that will help you prepare. No catching up.

As you prepare

1. What resistance have I noticed? What might it be telling me?

- ☐ ordinary reluctance
- ☐ a practical problem
- ☐ a concern about safety or readiness (see Lesson 5)
- ☐ something the quiet may surface (write it down and bring this page)

2. Is there a relationship or a known sin to address before I go, if it is safe and wise? What will I do, and when? (If no, or if it is not safe, write that down.)

You are never required to contact someone who has harmed you, or who is unsafe. Harm, abuse, crime or safety: seek qualified guidance. Confessing the same thing again and again? Speak with a pastor or a mental-health professional.

3. Who will pray for me on each retreat day, and what will I say?

"I am taking some days to be with God, and I would value your prayers."

While I am away

I will be away from

I will be back on

What needs doing, and who is doing it

What can wait until I return

For genuine emergencies only, contact (one person)

You have my permission to decide these matters without consulting me

“What you are doing is not good... You are not able to do it alone.” (Exodus 18:17–18, ESV)